



KATERINA, THE DEVIL'S HOUND

Medium undead (vampire), lawful evil — bound to the Devil of the Valley

Armor Class 16 (studded leather)

Hit Points 110 (13d8 + 52)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws Dex +7, Wis +5

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +7, Survival +8

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages the languages she knew in life

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP) Proficiency Bonus +3

TRAITS

Regeneration. Katerina regains 10 hit points at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 hit point and isn't in sunlight or running water. If she takes radiant damage or damage from holy water, this trait doesn't function at the start of her next turn.

Spider Climb. She can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down, without an ability check.

Vampire Weaknesses. She is harmed by running water, a stake to the heart while incapacitated, and sunlight (hypersensitivity).

Unrelenting Hunter. She has advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks to track prey and can't be surprised. Once she has a creature's scent, she knows its direction while on the same plane of existence.

Bound Will. While the Devil's command binds her, she has advantage on saves against being charmed or frightened, but disadvantage on any check to resist his orders. See "Breaking the Leash."

ACTIONS

Multiattack. She makes two attacks, only one of which can be a Bite.

Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing. Instead of dealing damage she can grapple the target (escape DC 14).

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one grappled, incapacitated, or willing creature. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing plus 10 (3d6) necrotic. The target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the necrotic damage, and Katerina regains that many hit points.

Hunter's Bolt (Recharge 5–6). Ranged Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. Hit: 13 (2d10 + 4) piercing, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength save or be knocked prone.

Call the Pack. (1/Day, Stage 2+) She summons 2 Shadow Hounds (see p.2) within 60 feet of her.

THE HUNT — A RECURRING THREAT

Katerina is not a single fight. The Devil looses her as a hound: she stalks the party across Barovia, testing them, wounding them, vanishing into the mist — exactly as her master would. Run her in three escalating stages.

Stage 1 — The Warning Early, on a misty road. A “too-coordinated” wolf attack; then she reveals herself, wounds one hero, and withdraws at 50% HP. She does not use Hunter's Bolt or Call the Pack. She tests — she does not kill.

Stage 2 — The Hunt After the party crosses the Devil's interests. She hunts them through a location with Hunter's Bolt and Call the Pack, and fights to 25% HP before melting into mist. She now knows their tactics (advantage on her first attack each encounter).

Stage 3 — The Reckoning Before the endgame. Unleashed (below), she makes her stand — to the death, or to freedom.

UNLEASHED (STAGE 3)

Her binding at full strain, Katerina sheds restraint. She gains 20 temporary hit points, immunity to the frightened condition, an additional Claw on her Multiattack, and the following bonus action:

Mist Step. Katerina teleports up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space she can see, leaving a swirl of cold mist in the space she left.

SHADOW HOUND

Large monstrosity (undead), unaligned

AC 14 (natural armor)

HP 37 (5d10 + 12)

Speed 50 ft.

Abilities STR 17 (+3) DEX 15 (+2) CON 15 (+2) INT 3 WIS 12 (+1) CHA 7

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +4 · Senses darkvision 60 ft. · CR 1 (200 XP)

Pack Tactics. The hound has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the hound's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and isn't incapacitated.

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 10 (2d6 + 3) piercing. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 13 Strength save or be knocked prone.

RUNNING THE HUNT — 3 WAYS TO DROP HER IN

On the Road Any wilderness travel through Barovia. The pack strikes first; Katerina finishes the scene with a single, deliberate wound — a promise, not a kill.

The Devil's Reward When the party helps the woman he covets, or takes something he wants, Strahd “rewards” them by loosing his hound. Stage 2 begins.

Krezk / the Abbey Where another is building a bride for the Devil, Katerina makes a fitting, tragic mirror — a hound where the Abbot makes a wife. A perfect place for the Reckoning.

BREAKING THE LEASH — ENDING THE HUNT WITHOUT A FIGHT

Katerina was Barovia's finest hunter — a protector of the roads — before the Devil bound her will. A party that would rather free her than destroy her can. Run it as a skill challenge: 3 successes before 3 failures.

1 • Learn who she was Investigation or History (DC 14), or find her abandoned hunting lodge in the woods — her horn, her oath, the names of those she once saved.

2 • Reach her without bloodshed Persuasion or Stealth (DC 15) to approach under a flag of grief rather than steel. Dealing damage to her adds a failure.

3 • Shatter the binding Present her hunting horn, speak her forsaken oath, or offer a true act of mercy: Persuasion, Insight, or Performance (DC 16). This is the moment her master's grip is weakest.

On success: Her will breaks. Choose the ending that fits your table: she turns on the Devil as an ally for a single scene, then crumbles to dust at peace — or she walks, unbound, into the first dawn she has seen in a lifetime.

On failure: The hunt resumes at the next stage — but she remembers the kindness, and hesitates once, when it matters most.